Unit 13B · The Ancient Egyptians

Speaking · 12 sets · for the teacher

How to use it. Pick a set, read the questions, point to the words. Let students answer in their own way: the green line is only a model. The first sets push today's grammar, the middle sets bring back older grammar, and the last sets are open and creative.

1 A day in Ancient Egypt

IMAGINE

Push these words: **lived** · worked · used · didn't have · clay

Tell me about a child in Ancient Egypt. Say where he lived.
→ He lived in a small clay house near the river.

Say what he used and what he didn't have.
→ He used clay tablets. He didn't have a computer or a phone.

Say what he did every day.
→ He helped his father on the farm and he played games.

Say how he felt.
→ He was tired in the evening, but he was happy.

2 Houses

IMAGINE

Push these words: **clay** · small · windows · didn't have

Describe an Egyptian house.
→ The house was small and it was made of clay.

Say what it didn't have.
→ It didn't have glass windows or a TV.

Say what people did in the house.
→ They cooked and they talked.

Would you like to live there? Why?
→ No, I wouldn't. It was hot and it didn't have a shower.

3 Children long ago

IMAGINE

Push these words: **helped** · played · didn't go · parents

Say what children did in the morning.
→ They helped their parents and they cleaned the house.

Say what they didn't do.
→ They didn't go to school and they didn't watch cartoons.

Say what games they played.
→ They played with small balls and they danced.

Say one thing you like about your life now.
→ I like school because I have friends.

4 Jobs

IMAGINE

Push these words: **worked** · farmer · writer · teacher · carried

Say what jobs Egyptians had.
→ They worked as farmers, teachers and writers.

Say what a farmer did.
→ A farmer planted wheat and carried water.

Say what a writer used.
→ A writer used papyrus and ink.

Say which job you liked more. Why?
→ I liked the writer's job more because it was quiet.

5 Food

IMAGINE

Push these words: **cooked** · bread · fish · fruit · loved

Say what Egyptians cooked.
→ They cooked bread and fish.

Say what they didn't have.
→ They didn't have pizza or chocolate.

Say what children loved.
→ Children loved fruit, like dates and figs.

Say one food you liked yesterday and one you didn't like.
→ I liked soup yesterday. I didn't like the salad.

6 Papyrus and paper

OPINION

Push these words: **light** · soft · heavy · easy · difficult · comes from

Say why papyrus was better than clay.
→ It was light and soft, so it was easy to carry.

Say where the word 'paper' comes from.
→ It comes from the word 'papyrus'.

Say why people used clay first.
→ Clay was easy to find, but it was heavy.

What do we use now?
→ We use paper and computers.

7 Yesterday at school

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **listened** · opened · closed · asked · answered

Tell me about yesterday at school. Use -ed verbs.
→ We listened to the teacher and we opened our books.

Say what the teacher asked.
→ She asked us about Egypt and we answered.

Say what you didn't do.
→ I didn't talk in class. I didn't shout.

Say one thing you enjoyed.
→ I enjoyed the story because it was funny.

8 Last weekend

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **visited** · walked · cooked · cleaned · enjoyed

Tell me about your weekend. Use three -ed verbs.
→ We visited my grandma, we cooked dinner and I cleaned my room.

Say where you walked.
→ I walked in the park with my dog.

Say what you didn't do.
→ I didn't watch TV and I didn't play computer games.

Was it a good weekend? Why?
→ Yes, it was. I enjoyed it because I wasn't tired.

9 A museum visit

IMAGINE

Push these words: **looked at** · found out · papyrus · clay · museum

Imagine you visited a museum. Say what you looked at.
→ I looked at an old papyrus and a clay tablet.

Say what you learned.
→ I learned that Egyptians didn't have paper.

Say what you liked most.
→ I liked the golden mask. It was beautiful.

Say what you wanted to touch, but you didn't.
→ I wanted to touch the papyrus, but I didn't.

10 Old and new

OPINION

Push these words: **used** · didn't use · easier · because · now

Say one thing people used then and don't use now.
→ People used clay tablets. Now they don't use them.

Is writing easier now? Why?
→ Yes, it is, because we have paper and computers.

What did people have then that we don't have now?
→ They had quiet evenings. They didn't have noisy phones.

Which life is better for you, then or now? Why?
→ Now, because I like cartoons and I like school.

11 Fairy tale in the past

IMAGINE

Push these words: **lived** · wanted · knocked · opened · laughed

Retell the goat story in the past. Start: Once there lived...
→ A mother goat lived in a house in a forest. She had three little goats.

Say what the wolf wanted.
→ The wolf wanted to eat the little goats.

Say what the goats didn't do.
→ They didn't open the door.

Say how the story ended.
→ The wolf jumped away and the goats laughed.

12 My great-grandparents

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **lived** · worked · didn't have · walked · loved

Imagine your great-grandparents' life. Say where they lived.
→ They lived in a village. They worked on a farm.

Say what they didn't have.
→ They didn't have a car or a refrigerator.

Say how they travelled.
→ They walked to the market or used a horse.

Say what they loved.
→ They loved their garden and their family.